

**THOMAS JEFFERSON****1801–09**

The main author of the Declaration of Independence, which stated that the colonies would no longer accept British rule.

**JAMES MADISON****1809–17**

Helped draw up the US Constitution, which set out America's laws and guaranteed certain rights for its citizens.

**JAMES MONROE****1817–25**

Remembered for the Monroe Doctrine, which declared that the USA would resist attempts by other countries to establish colonies in the Americas.

**JOHN QUINCY ADAMS****1825–29**

Son of a previous president, John Adams. After his presidency, he became a strong campaigner against slavery.

**ANDREW JACKSON****1829–37**

Before he took office, he became a national hero for leading the army that defeated the British at the Battle of New Orleans.

**MARTIN VAN BUREN****1837–41**

After financial panic and stock market crash led to economic depression, Van Buren became unpopular and was not re-elected.

**JAMES BUCHANAN****1857–61**

Like previous presidents, he tried to make peace between states on the slavery issue, but by the end of his term, civil war was looming.

**ABRAHAM LINCOLN****1861–65**

Opposed to slavery, he led the country during four years of civil war. Days after the war ended, he was shot dead by John Wilkes Booth.

**ANDREW JOHNSON****1865–69**

Put on trial by the Senate for violating the Tenure of Office Act, he escaped being removed from office by a single vote.

**ULYSSES S. GRANT****1869–77**

A hero of the Civil War, he was an inexperienced politician whose presidency was overshadowed by scandal and corruption.

**RUTHERFORD B. HAYES****1877–81**

After winning one of the closest presidential elections ever, he fought to end corruption in politics and public life.

**JAMES A. GARFIELD****1881**

Shot dead after only 200 days in office, before he could carry out his promise to reform the civil service and other public bodies.

**WOODROW WILSON****1913–21**

Took the USA into World War I in 1917. After the war, he proposed the formation of the League of Nations to try to prevent future conflict.

**WARREN G. HARDING****1921–23**

An unpopular president who was dogged by rumours of financial wrongdoing. He died suddenly, before an investigation could begin.

**CALVIN COOLIDGE****1923–29**

Honest, hard-working, and modest, he was fondly nicknamed "Silent Cal". Under his presidency, the US economy boomed.

**HERBERT HOOVER****1929–33**

Shortly after his election, the USA began an era of serious economic depression. Hoover was blamed and did not win a second term.

**FRANKLIN D. ROOSEVELT****1933–45**

Led the USA through the Great Depression and World War II. He funded a plan to revive the US economy and help people out of poverty.

**HARRY S. TRUMAN****1945–53**

Authorized the dropping of two nuclear bombs on Japan, which ended World War II. Took the USA to war with Korea.

**RONALD REAGAN****1981–89**

An ex-Hollywood star, he helped to end the Cold War. He was shot by a would-be assassin but recovered.

**GEORGE H. W. BUSH****1989–93**

An oil tycoon and ex-head of the CIA, he took the USA and its allies into the first Gulf War with Iraq (1990–91).

**BILL CLINTON****1993–2001**

Presided over a time of peace and prosperity, but his reputation was damaged by a scandal over a relationship with a White House worker.

**GEORGE W. BUSH****2001–09**

After the terrorist attacks of 9/11, he ordered the invasion of Afghanistan and declared the War on Terror.

**BARACK OBAMA****(2009–)**

The first African American president. His healthcare reforms were disliked by opponents, and led to stalemate in government.

A US PRESIDENT CAN ONLY BE ELECTED TWICE, SERVING UP TO TEN YEARS